

Dec 1, 2025

Strolid Leadership Call - Transcript

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Shawna Behen: Hi, Sergey.

Sergey Lyapustin: All right.

Joe Furnari: everyone.

Jason Branham: Sergey Joe.

Joe Furnari: Happy post Thanksgiving.

Michael Donovan: What's happening?

Jason Branham: Michael, are you in a different location or just a different room?

Michael Donovan: I'm in the same room in the same seat on a different computer because I don't know what's going on with my my main.

Joe Furnari: Come

Michael Donovan: So, yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Good morning everyone.

Jason Branham: Morning.

Sergey Lyapustin: Hello.

Joe Furnari: on.

Vinnie Micciche: Um, what's going on with this um, VCON show? Is everybody in Washington DC or something or when does that take place, Matt?

Matt Watson: I'm only going up Thursday to meet with everybody when it's done. But yeah, I think sounds like Chris may go up there and talk. Perry's going to be there. Probably Mitch. Mitch always goes to those. There's Thomas. He'll answer it.

Thomas Howe: What?

Matt Watson: Give us the rundown on the VCON show.

Thomas Howe: Yes, he's out.

Vinnie Micciche: When's it? When's it start?

Thomas Howe: Dinner Tuesday night.

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Thomas Howe: Tomorrow night then.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. And are we sponsoring anything?

Thomas Howe: Yeah. Yeah. We were sponsoring that that dinner and we picked up the uh room on uh Thursday for the VCON Foundation meeting.

Vinnie Micciche: How much is it all going to cost us?

Thomas Howe: Couple grand.

Vinnie Micciche: The room is is isn't that expensive?

Thomas Howe: Yeah. Yeah. Our budget was two grand for all of it.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. And it's in Washington DC.

Thomas Howe: Yep.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Thomas Howe: Yep. And um the first day is at uh Pillsbury, I think, the law firm, and the second day is at um Virginia Tech. And we got Eric Burger is hosting us there, which is nice.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. Just um after the show, we got to start watching expenses pretty closely. Um I gonna have to talk to um Perry about that. Um unless of course things turn around dramatically on the BDC side. Um we got some serious churn problems um ending this month or or or coming after this month.

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Vinnie Micciche: Um and uh we got to replace that business. And you know, I'm starting to feel it. I hope everybody is. I don't know if Joe has any financial data on that, but cash flow is going to start becoming an issue. We got to really put the pedal to the metal on uh raising money for VCON because that's can help the Straw business quite a bit if we can figure out how to how to do that. For some reason, Perry canceled our meeting tomorrow at 9ine, but probably because he was traveling to the show.

Thomas Howe: Yeah, I think he's traveling. I think he's traveling. That's right.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. Do you have anything else planned besides this, Thomas?

Thomas Howe: In terms of like travel, I've got a nothing nothing concrete, nothing nothing really important.

Vinnie Micciche: No, just events and money spending and things like that. I'd just like to Yeah.

Thomas Howe: I think I've got a IETF in March, which is China, which is crazily much cheaper than Vancouver.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

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Vinnie Micciche: Where is that? Where is that this year? Oh god.

Thomas Howe: It cost me 1,500 bucks to get to Vancouver and 500 like 400 bucks a night.

Vinnie Micciche: Where in China?

Thomas Howe: remember uh uh Shenzen it's the uh it's the Silicon Valley of China and for the and normally when I go out to ITF site I I get Airbnb because it's cheaper. This time it's in the L meridian which is a great great hotel for 120 bucks a night.

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Thomas Howe: I don't ask me why China is so just crazily cheap compared to every place else I go.

Vinnie Micciche: Well,

Thomas Howe: The only thing which is not going to be cheap is they told me that I'm going to be taken aside and interrogated for a day.

Matt Watson: Yeah, that's why

Jason Branham: Is that room right next to the microwave unit?

Thomas Howe: What they're going to like, you know, interrogate me, make sure I get baked in. Well, this is this is where my two government jobs are going to screw me. I'm They're gonna they're going to they're going to make sure they talk to me.

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Michael Donovan: Scotch tape and a big pen, man.

Thomas Howe: Scotch and a big pen.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, a little trade craft. We'll uh do a sidebar on that some other no hard drives.

Thomas Howe: Yeah. I was told to bring nothing. No. No personal electronics.

Vinnie Micciche: They'll be watching your move.

Thomas Howe: Yep. They will actually between AI and the government stuff.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Thomas Howe: They're gonna

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. So, I want to just jump I want to just jump into what I sent everybody. Um, and forgive me for um sending out lots of different um you know, ideas and thoughts, but that's like I said in the email, you know, welcome to my brain. This is how I learn and this is how I vet things out as I continue to keep pushing and pushing on it until it starts to become really clear. So ultimately what's got me a little, you know,

what's what's a bit scary that I see coming is um what I've been demoing for for dealers um which is that Straw GPT is chat GPT, right?

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Vinnie Micciche: And it also has their conversations in their inventory. And when you when you interact with it from a customer perspective, it's already doing things that I couldn't comprehend a year ago, right, that it could do. Um, it can help me pick a car in inventory. It can it can answer pricing questions. It can give payments, trade values, uh comes with the disclaimers already built in. So I started thinking like myself personally and I ask a lot of questions to people around me to just get perspective u outside of the business and I haven't found too many people under 30 years old that has eliminated using Google and uses chat GPT or Gemini or or what have you versus Google search. So logically I come to the thought that if Google search is less uh informative than LLMs and and obviously you've seen my usage uh with chat GPT um it's just inevitable that these LLMs are going to start to become uh you know relied people are going to rely on them for information more and more as time goes on and as that as I started playing through that I started asking it questions like okay well what's going to happen to website traffic and it basically without it doesn't say maybe it says it's going to go away it's going to diminish it's going to decrease and then I started thinking well what about all these

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Vinnie Micciche: widget companies and tools so I came up with the idea of putting astrology gpt on you know Mike Blog and D David's site and they were all excited about it. They want it on there right away and and initially chat GBT told me don't waste your time doing that because eventually no one's going to go to the website. This is how I went down this rabbit hole just so you know. And I kept drilling in saying okay well where are they going to go and they're going to go to the LMS and the LLMs are going to become marketplaces kind of like Amazon. I mean no Mike's on the call. So u okay what's going to happen to digital retailing tools? Well we almost built one in 2019 and we didn't. Thank God. We also almost built a a chat platform in around the same time when we're talking to Ford and Toyota and we didn't and I'm glad we didn't. Um and we focused more on the infrastructure which is you know VCON and and Conserver.

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Vinnie Micciche: So we have a um foundational layer of data uh for dealers. Um and we already have a a chat widget which is astrology BT if we look at it that way. And so I started really digging even deeper and you know even companies like Cars.com, Autotrader, CarGurus, they're go they're going to be eliminated eventually and I'm sure they see that coming. Um so anyway, it said not to waste your time putting a widget on dealers's website because it won't be traffic. But then I that that's five years from now is basically what I what I came up with. So initially that is a good starting point. Um but I I and here's another really ironic thing is I bought David Rosenberg when he saw astrology BT originally he said it was like a dealer MRI like an examination of the dealer. So I bought the URL dealer MRI and then Thomas started talking about co c co-pilots. I couldn't buy autoco-pilot, but I bought automotive copilot.com. And so the way I and I'll pull up the document in a second, but the way I see this is, you know, Straw becomes the AIBDC, so to speak.

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Vinnie Micciche: I don't know we can work on the messaging or the wording around that but we have we have um the dealer co-pilot which is the widget for the website but can also be for dealer staff it could also be for B you know astrolog BDC which is something I've been saying for like four or five months like we should our agents should have access to this in their dialer right astrology GPT can ask it questions it can write emails it can write texts it's a co-pilot pretty much. I mean, it can do more co-pilots, the way Thomas describes them are it can coach you and and train you as you're you're doing your job. But if if you guys really start using ChachiPT, what you're going to start seeing is a lot of the questions our BDC answers are going to be answered by these co-pilots. product information um you know avail you know inventory. Now, one thing I got it to to tell me was that it will never give an exact payment or an exact trade value or it will never but it but you know I it's interesting because when digital retailing came out I I was a proponent I I was against it because I said people don't care about exact when they're shopping.

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Vinnie Micciche: They want to have an idea. They want a general idea of what the payment is going to be, what the lease payment is going to be, roughly what my trade's going to be, where when they're starting. They don't care about exact payments until they're in a buying mode, right? So, if you think about that journey, we train it to our agents, researchers, shoppers, and buyers. There's three different types of customers we deal with. The buyers are where where people are going to be needed. And I'm having a meeting on Wednesday and Thursday. I haven't figured out exactly how I'm going to frame this with the people in the company, but the way I see this unfolding, and you just have to trust me. My instincts are really, really good on this stuff when I start feeling it. The inst the instincts are on point. Just trust me on that. The people that are really good at their job are still going to be needed. The salespeople that really know how to take care of customers are going to be needed.

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Vinnie Micciche: So then then I started going down the path with with Chad GBT saying, "Okay, well if leads if dealers aren't going to get traffic to their website, where are the leads going to come from?" And guess what I found out? None of these LLMs have a solution to take that customer journey from them to the dealer. It doesn't exist. And it actually told me we should capitalize on that. It's a huge opportunity because all these customers that are on getting these ideas, these rough, you know, estimates and so forth, they're going to say, "Well, I'm buying it. What's the exact price?" And basically what it does, if you if you've used the LLM, it tells you, "I can connect you with a dealer." But right now, all it does is list the dealer's information and phone number and stuff. It has no way of of taking that customer from that point, capturing all that information that the LLM captured and passing it on to the dealer and we could be that that middleware. And that's kind of where I want Mike to speak up on because I know you're probably working on similar stuff at Amazon when you get these bots and then they kind of really need a human involved and things

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Thomas Howe: All

Vinnie Micciche: like that. That's kind of where where I'm at with all of this, you know, modeling for the future of how this whole thing plays out.

Thomas Howe: right.

Vinnie Micciche: That could be too big of a lift and maybe, you know, we don't have enough resources or funding to get to that point. But it made it sound like we're are it didn't make it sound like we are already halfway there with what we've developed. So that's what this kind of um I'll share this now with you just because I want to hear your thoughts on it. Um forget about the way we're doing things today. We really need to kind of get in a frame of mind of where this is headed. So, Co-Pilot is more of the widget and the assistant for the customer, the dealer, and our agents. That's like in the dialer on the website kind of idea. That's the co-pilot. You ask it questions, it helps you. The brain is astrology PT or as we we're calling it today.

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Vinnie Micciche: It's in the portal. it becomes the dealer's um you know go-to for any any information that it needs um like we have it designed today. They call it the conversational brain, but you got to think that that's more for the owner GM or people using the portal that are trying to, you know, help improve their business. So that's kind of how I see it right there is like those are our two main uh anchors for marketing for selling. Strolled now becomes a different company. It's not a BDC company anymore. And the other point that I'm trying to get my head around is the dealer owns this data, not Chat GPT or not not the world. Um, and that's powerful because and it's not only do they own it, but they own it in a in a um they own it in a um form of like uh that's that's compliant that's uh ready for AI with the MCP server and all that kind of stuff. Like they can take this data and share anywhere they want.

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Vinnie Micciche: It's portable and it's secure. So like dealers don't really care about that or understand that. That's the problem with that last statement. But it's it's it's hugely it's very powerful. So I mean I don't know have you guys gone through this? Have you have you have you u thought about it at all or do you see the vision or the idea of how we because this is going to be transformed into our website into our marketing into our you know everything that we do. It's almost like we're not a BDC. We're more of a, you know,

an AI company as uh Perry keeps telling me. Any thoughts?

Matt Watson: Yeah, it it makes sense. And the approach is is I think with any AI product, let's just pick something and and tackle it one piece at a time. And I think the word that we've got to adopt here, which is a little bit of a buzz word, but it's also what we need to make, is the agents, right? We've got to start building agents that work together, ones that understand inventory and ones that can handle pricing and and stay compliant.

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Matt Watson: And as we build those out and get them to where we can turn them into a product, right, we combine them to do different things, whether that's our agent, the customer, the dealer, the salesperson at the dealership, etc. So, we just we've got to pick the shortest path first, I think, right? What are our early wins?

Thomas Howe: Yeah. Yeah. Totally agree with you. I mean, one

Joe Furnari: Yeah, I think Vinnie, I mean I I I made some notes, went through it. Um I think there's three unique uh what I would call very very strong advantages. First, I do think it creates this kind of full endto-end closed loop conversational stack which no one in the industry has. I know that we sit there and we message the technology but as we know the adoption is a little bit low or not where we would like it. So I think by bringing this kind of closed loop kind of conversation technology all in and really being that endto-end solution the outcome there is you're going to be a sticky solution right now excuse me once that is

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Mike Sullivan: That's right.

Joe Furnari: actually delivered and there's no competition that even remotely has that. Secondly, I think you highlighted this here is you're going to get quick wins with the dealer. You're going to get faster response times. You're going to get um more leads and the quality of those leads are going to be significantly better than what they are today. And then the other thing is it's going to open a bigger TAM for us. And what I mean by that is you're going to as you mentioned in your document, you're going to have doors open up with OEMs and other marketplaces uh much more than what we see today. So I think just in summary, those are the three things that clearly um will create that benefit here. To Matt's point, um I do think we just kind of figure out what elements we can

deliver on fast. And this approach of two, three, you know, four, five, whatever the number is going to be, probably less than five dealers that we pilot it with. Then we get that feedback.

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Joe Furnari: We iterate, we build, we advance, enhance. Um and is Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, the way I laid this out though, it does kind of explain we start with the co-pilot and we already have the dealer brain to some degree in the portal which is our astrology PT where they can prompt

Joe Furnari: Yeah. Exactly.

Vinnie Micciche: it and ask questions. that's kind of that has to kind of evolve more into better data uh reporting information that's coming out of that those conversations than we currently do. Right now we built it to say, "Hey, you don't know how to prompt, so here are some prompts to to ask astrology BT questions." But, you know, one thing I've been talking to Kevin about um quite a bit is the the data within those conversations needs to be unlocked in a way that's easy for them to understand. We created signals which is is great. Um but it has to be more matured. It has to mature more like in terms of you know what what is the quality of the output and what is the quantity of the output.

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Vinnie Micciche: So um that's kind of where we got to go with the dealer brain.

Matt Watson: Right.

Vinnie Micciche: But that's why I'm saying the foundation is already there for us. We already have a lot of these components in place. It's just a matter of enhancing them for customer experience, agent experience, the salespeople in the sales for one of the things about like um uh Darwin. Darwin's a digital retailing tool that everyone, you know, a lot of dealers signed up with, a lot of OEMs signed up with, you know, Rosenberg started putting that a process around Darwin in his showroom. So when a customer came in, they both went on the website and started asking it questions and put inputting information to show the to work a deal at the desk. And I thought that was pretty, you know, forward thinking of him at the time. But all of that, you know, is gone with LLMs. You don't necessarily need a Darwin anymore, which is pretty scary for these these

companies. But you do need a human to understand at a high level how to communicate with a customer and how to take care of a customer.

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Vinnie Micciche: And I think that's what we, you know, that's the message I'm going to get across to our team is the days of clicking buttons and managing CRM and all the admin and stuff. You're going to be good at talking to customers or you not. You're going to be good at taking care of customers or you're not. That's kind of where I think it's headed. That's I know that that that's kind of like the core of what I'm feeling from all this. As a matter of fact, Chad GBT also told me they see Strollet as an incredibly important powerful uh position to to to tell the LLMs what dealers they can trust. It's like a trust layer for them and that's what they need. So, we almost have to be no longer a BDC when it gets to that point. Now you're talking three to four years from now before it gets to that. But now it's like, okay, the the customer passes the information to Straw. Straw warms up the lead, passes it to the dealer.

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Vinnie Micciche: What did the dealer do with it? And if they're not doing anything with it, they're going to go out of business. But if they if they understand the power of what's coming, if it does unfold the way I just explained it, they can be very successful if they really focus on a customer experience. And I think that's kind of where I'm what I got out of all out of all my research is that that's got to improve and uh we could be that trust layer kind of the way uh Shift Digital is for the OEMs. You know, Shift Digital sits between the OEM and the dealer and basically tells the OEMs what what dealers are good at answering leads and stuff like that, right?

Mike Sullivan: I can't.

Vinnie Micciche: We could potentially be that for these LLMs in the automotive vertical. That's what I'm saying.

Michael Donovan: What's that based on?

Thomas Howe: Yeah, just that we our replacement for ship digital.

Vinnie Micciche: What's what based on?

Michael Donovan: Like what what source of of data? Like how do how is it deterministic?

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Michael Donovan: No, that were the shift digital in between the dealer and the customer.

Vinnie Micciche: I mean between the LLM and the and the dealer, the customers using the LLM. That's what I'm saying. What I found out was Chachebt, Gemini, none of these comp none of these companies, they can give customers information, but they can't give definitive information. Number one, and number two, they have no way of passing that customer to a dealer. So, it's almost like becoming like the Shopify for for automotive in this in that way. And I'm not I know that's kind of sounds really far-fetched potentially and how could Strawa do it, but we already have the bones. We already have the infrastructure, right?

Michael Donovan: So currently that happens. How the LLM is current currently passes shopper inquiries when they get or you know research and they they eventually get to that buyer stage, right?

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Michael Donovan: How what does the LLM do today to pass?

Vinnie Micciche: just gives a list of dealers in your area with contact information.

Michael Donovan: Okay.

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Vinnie Micciche: Most of them are giving you uh a static email address, not a lead email address. So, it go into someone's inbox, which is crazy.

Michael Donovan: Oh, it's you you've had that. You've experienced that.

Vinnie Micciche: Oh, yeah. Buddy, I've been I've been going deep on this stuff like for weeks now. It is I'm trying to understand the journey and it's not good. it it's good until I mean this is what's going to happen. If they don't have a way to pass it to the dealer, the customer is going to show up and the dealer's going to go, "Yeah, chatbt doesn't know what they're talking about. Let's start the deal from the beginning and put you through the torture chamber of of of interrogating you in the showroom, right?" Like, that's what's going to happen if they don't have a way to pass it through. That's how I see it. I'm not saying that, by the way, that's the that's down the road. That's not right now.

Michael Donovan: Mhm. Right.

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Vinnie Micciche: That's where we need to see this unfold, right? Potentially.

Michael Donovan: Okay. So, so right now what's happening is, you know, they get they get a lead on a dealer, right? The the the buyer or the researcher. Here's a here's a local dealer that has what you need. They go to the dealer's website. They call the dealer. They visit the dealership. It's one of those things, right?

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Michael Donovan: Okay. So, we're going to start with the layer of tech, new technology.

Vinnie Micciche: I I guess from my point of view, my point of view, I'm a customer. I'm frustrated that an LLM can give me this information and a dealer can't. We have a VCON engine server.

Michael Donovan: Yep.

Vinnie Micciche: We can capture that whole interaction on the LLM and push it into a dealer CRM in a secure way and solid can warm that lead up for the customer as well for the dealer and the customer.

Michael Donovan: through a chatbot, right? Is what you're saying, right?

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Vinnie Micciche: That's how I see it. I'm not saying it's going to work out that way, but it's a clear path from customer experience on these these tools to a dealer.

Michael Donovan: But that's how you see it.

Vinnie Micciche: There's no right now. Think about how much money was made by Autotrader, Cars.com, CarGurus just generating leads for dealers.

Michael Donovan: or not generating

Vinnie Micciche: LM have LM have to figure that out or they're not, you know, it's going to be a dead end. They have to and it's not just automotive. It's going to be other verticals as well. I mean, if they're going to be that marketplace like it says it's going to be in with by 2030, it's going to eliminate all these marketplaces and everyone's going to use these LLMs. That's pretty much what it's telling me. And also, I thought Google was in trouble, but it makes it sound like Google's actually in the driver's seat because they already have the dealer network and they can start charging dealers for this kind of stuff going forward.

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Sergey Lyapustin: So are we go?

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, I know I'm getting sci-fi and deep on you guys, but like the reality is if you start with a co-pilot, you already start capturing you already start capturing those um conversations on the dealer's websites. as the dealer's websites start uh traffic starts to diminish, there has to be another way for dealers to get, you know, leads from customers.

Michael Donovan: Let's go.

Vinnie Micciche: If if that's how it plays out, Listen, I'm

Matt Watson: Yep. So, we need to the team this morning was asking for direction. We we were originally going to start testing a a chat widget whether it's our current one we improve or a second one on our dealers websites which I think is a great start. Are we still good on that plan? That's what it sounds like. Capture

Vinnie Micciche: so excited about this idea that I'm I'm going full force um raising money and and that's that's because we we we have to we can't do but continue to do it on a service uh revenue. Um and and and this is a it's basically a conversational CRM is what we're we're talking about uh to some type of an adapter from AI to the dealer CRM.

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Vinnie Micciche: The dealer CRM will still exists, but there has to be that middle layer in my opinion from from what I'm thinking through because otherwise it's going to be disconnected. Tony Petraelli has an avatar and he tells me I can put it on any website and you can be the GM and you can talk to your customers and give them any qu answer any question they want. I said that's great Tony but what happens when the customer comes in the showroom and nobody knows anything about what happened on that conversation you had on the website because that's what happens. No one wants to talk about that and the customer gets frustrated because they start them with a four square and start you know asking them what's interest you know what interested them in the Toyota Camry and what are they trading and they already gave that information to a to a to a a tool right that's the reality of what really happens in the car business that that disconnection is is the biggest problem even with these LL

Michael Donovan: Let's go.

Vinnie Micciche: even with these digital retailing tools People go down this path and then they go into the showroom and five car Fred wants to uh you know show them something they're not interested in. Take an hour and a half to get all their trade information when they already gave it.

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Vinnie Micciche: That's the frustration customers have with car car buying.

Michael Donovan: So are we are we going to become a a conversion point you know like like the the the website widget? I mean historically the national average for for form conversion lead conversion first party on automotive websites is under 2%.

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Michael Donovan: So let's just take the total sum of 100% say 20% are there for service that leaves us with 80%. So and the and the net of 78%. So out of the 2% conversion a small percentage is is chat. It's it's arguably the smallest percentage is chat. So, how do we solve that problem if this is what we're going to do?

Vinnie Micciche: anyone.

Mike Sullivan: Uh Vinnie, Mike, uh just um again listening and processing and and uh you know you've you've done a lot of of exploration mentally around the around the space. Um the the the best I can say is uh LLMs are part of an infrastructure. They're part of an orchestration uh play. You asked if AWS is doing this kind of stuff.

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Mike Sullivan: Yes, it's all agentic work. It's all AI apps. And so wherever the LLM sits, it needs to feed into functional AI applications that perform functions that otherwise can direct customers this way or that way for this decision or that decision. So, I think what really ultimately needs to occur, Matt said it, right? Let there needs to be there. There's nobody on this call that is confused about the buyer journey in the car business. You all know that stuff. So if you can map that out and identify areas where you want to bring AI applications or automation to bear, then the LLM is one step in that overarching process that allows Straw to establish itself as you say Vinnie the middleware. But, you know, LLM it the they're they play a a limited role probably at the top of the funnel until you move people into functional performing apps that are doing what a team used to do or what an individual used to do. from billing to pricing to recommending uh to to

surveying specs on cars that are available.

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Mike Sullivan: All that stuff can get done. We just need to pick one string of behavior and give it a shot. I think as Matt said and Michael's asking, you know, the right questions in terms of where where LLMs are able to extract customers or where are they going to capture decision points? But again, it all comes down to what everyone is now doing, which is building agentic contextualized platforms or frameworks that are in vertical spaces, whether that's manufacturing or healthcare or whatever. You guys may be the first in car, but that's what's happening. And um you know it's a more elaborate architecture, but it really centers in on functional AI applications that are again living a role inside of that of that value chain. That's the best I can offer. I think it comes down to simplifying picking a path and uh and trying to build something around that. I would look to sir uh Sergey uh that you know that's all stuff that that can be cobbled together. But um early quick beta test is probably the right way to go and again M Matt said it early in the conversation.

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Mike Sullivan: So that's that's what I can tell you.

Vinnie Micciche: All right. So, this is what I did on Lovable just to start us off. Um, that's a digital retailing tool, but it's also a chat widget. The only thing I don't like about this is it reminds me of chat which maybe it should because people are familiar with chat but this can be built uh pretty easily. Uh we already have you know I want information on payments. This thing is so I mean you have to play with uh astrology and start asking it what kind of cars do you have in inventory? It's going to list it out and then run me a payment on this, you know, give me my We have to kind of coach people, I think, today because I'm not sure everybody's using uh LLMs as much as I am and and and digging deep with them and and really prompting the hell out of it to get get it to give you the right information. So, you you start them off once they start to realize that, hey, this is like a salesperson right here and it never gives an actual answer.

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Vinnie Micciche: That's what scares me about this this this technology is a lot of the stuff we train our our agents on on overcoming objections and how to you know handle you know questions basically.

Mike Sullivan: Enjoy.

Vinnie Micciche: I mean do you want to know the truth? We teach our people to avoid everything and try to get an appointment out of them. Meanwhile, these LLMs are giving them the information in a in a you know, an estimated, you know, they're estimating information, but they're not given exact information. And and that's what I'm saying. That's where that handoff has to come to a to, you know, a highly qualified person at that point. Not somebody that's going to, you know, try to, you know, dance around the questions or at least let them know we're going to get that information for you and get it to the right people at the dealership. So anyway, if we were to build something like this out, put it on a dealer's website, our dealers would be thrilled.

Michael Donovan: So it this almost looks like it its own platform like it's independent like it's for the shopper for the buyer and And

00:36:00

Vinnie Micciche: Why? I know I just threw this together. I didn't put a whole a ton of thought into I mean, I put a lot of thought into it, but I just, you know, basically told Lovable what I wanted, and that's what it created.

Michael Donovan: well, look, I I think that this as a standalone platform is extremely powerful and it connects everything uh that you that you've mentioned. Just just my thought, but uh doesn't make it right or or wrong. I I could see this standing.

Mike Sullivan: Yeah, but it's a good thought.

Michael Donovan: This could stand on its own and put autotrader, cars.com, car gurus. Don't worry about the dealer website.

Vinnie Micciche: Well, I already got Mike Blog.

Michael Donovan: This is the destination.

Vinnie Micciche: I already got Mike Blog not signing up with AutoFi, which is another digital retailing tool.

Michael Donovan: But

Vinnie Micciche: They're spending two Hold up, Michael. They're spending two grand. I know Mike wants to say something, too. They're spending two grand a month on these digital retailing platforms.

00:37:02

Vinnie Micciche: They don't need them anymore, really. is no. What I found, maybe I'm wrong, but digital retailing tools never sell a car. They're just there for informational purposes and they force you down this funnel of step one, give me this, step two. This way here, the customers in control of what they want to know. It's not forcing you through a a a a you know, f a funnel pretty much. What are you gonna say, Mike?

Mike Sullivan: Uh I'm what I'm saying is there are already in this landscape of AI companies like Lovable or NADN that have already built giant chunks of horizontal functionality that can be taken up and exploited and leveraged and used. lovable is terrific. And uh um you know, again, it it really comes down to the interactions in this retail environment that are guiding customers to confess what their specs are, what they want, how they want it, what their price range. All of that stuff can be done, but it needs then to be as you say, right, that needs to trigger some other function that starts to recommend or starts to give some results that can that can be an AI application that sits underneath or behind or alongside of something like lovable.

00:38:32

Mike Sullivan: So, it's not that far off. We just need to architect it mentally and find a role for each of the components and test it.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, that's one component, right? Is basically what you're saying.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah, I I I I think I think like uh like lovable and basically every LLM they have that general knowledge about the areas and topics.

Mike Sullivan: Yes.

Sergey Lyapustin: So what we can like do and what we can uh kind of fulfill is uh tools to give like special information like we can uh like for example inventory. Our power is we have access to inventory and we can technically easily uh grant access to all dealerships inventory. we are like MCP or tools uh which can be connected in that kind of general uh assistant bot or whatever we we have u decide on the name for that tool like u dealer copilot whatever and uh we can build one tool at a time like we can build inventory we can build appointment scheduler payments with more detailed and exact information based on the dealer's needs And yeah that that way we can enhance it like that

00:39:48

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: general knowledge which you can get those answers like just by going to the chat GPT for some questions but you can get like vehicle availability for a particular dealer or if they have anything special in the tradeins or if they have any special conditions or whatever that uh we can kind of fulfill it and I do like what uh it can uh essentially work through the lead up to the point and that lead going to be ready to jump on the deal or it might need some I don't know we might have some special request or whatever like he might ask for whatever any extra photos or whatever which we can't technically do through that too and that's when we want someone from uh our team or from the dealership to join into that and we can kind of guide that uh customer through that journey up to that uh step and he ready to join

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. And I just all I'm going to say to that, Sergey, is I think you're right. However, I um have been in the business 30 years and I can't believe how it's not just general information.

00:41:08

Vinnie Micciche: It's actually really good information. I mean, it's given residual values and lease lease uh you know, figures and and and given ranges on on rates and things like that. And it's basically explaining also that it's giving ranges and these aren't exact, but but it's it's exactly what I would want as a dealer to give to the customer in the way it gives it because it breaks down

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: the barriers. It breaks down the walls between the customer and the dealer when you when you're sharing that kind of information. And they don't let BDC's do that. They don't let salespeople do that, which is a sin. They let digital retailing tools do it. Uh but the disclaimers are there. Everything's there that says, you know, if you want AC exact payments or information, let me connect you with a dealer. And then when you ask it to connect you with a dealer, it gives you, you know, a phone number and a dealer name that's in your zip code, right? kind of like what Google does now in a way.

00:42:07

Mike Sullivan: Yeah, but it doesn't handle the last mile, Vinnie.

Vinnie Micciche: No, it doesn't. You're right.

Mike Sullivan: What you're talking It doesn't handle the last mile. Last mile is rag technology, which is another element. I'm sure Sergy Sergey knows. So uh re retrieval augmented generation which is really the specificity and context where you want to finally pay off on all the work that LLM have done to get a customer in position. You then want to bring very specific information inside of the conversation that actually can direct a customer to some other place where they can make a decision. But rag is part of the whole architecture. I think we just need to map it out.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. No, no, no. I I agree with you, Mike, but uh here's where I'm going to disagree with you is I think that's where it's been hung up for years.

Michael Donovan: All right.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Mike Sullivan: It is right.

Vinnie Micciche: And I don't think LLMs or AI are going to solve the people to people.

00:42:59

Vinnie Micciche: That's where people to people need to take over in my opinion.

Mike Sullivan: But they Yes, but they need to take over after, you know, with the last 10% instead of in the middle of the 60%.

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Mike Sullivan: Right. That's that's what that's what all of this efficiency and automation and optimization and acceleration is meant to do. My only point is my my my point is the LLMs are really powerful. The generalized chat GPTs, right, the Gox perplexity, they're all very very solid and they do produce a a wild uh amount of very useful information. to finally close them. There needs to be one more piece that creates that middleware, which is Rag and some other automation or AI application work that Strolled can bring to the table that can help your dealers finally bring a deal.

Harinder Bhinder: So, sorry.

Sergey Lyapustin: I I think I think what so sorry just one quick things about Michael point about the low conversion rate on the chat bots in general. uh I guess uh it used to

be what the chatbot can't provide really useful information and it it's normally just try to transfer that to their uh support team or whatever and at least my experience with the chat bots they they they just generally useless but if we can uh extend and give them uh more information and be able to answer quickly on into the point like if I'm on a dealer website it can give

00:44:29

Sergey Lyapustin: me all the information. I don't need to try to scroll through the website or call anyone. We can generally sell it as uh as as a way how we can increase conversion rate on all your chat uh visitors and kind of sell it uh this way and it give us kind of more ability to test it. That's that's and we also have the chat widget in place already. It would not require us to ask for another permission from the dealer. Try to kind of collaborate is there uh I don't know security team or anything just kind of use that uh real estate which we already own but enhance it.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. And I just I and I'm not I'm just pushing back because that's what I like to do. But when it comes to can you can you do what Mike's saying and and and and pull it off uh more effectively and more, you know, more penny perfect information to a customer? Sure. But there are too many variables that go on within a car dealership that's going to screw that up and create a tremendous amount of liability if you get if you let the the LLM take it way too far.

00:45:42

Vinnie Micciche: For example, cars saying it's available it's not right or the program changed or you know trade values change all kinds of different stuff changes.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: It's it's a moving target um the car business. So like you've got to cut it off at some point and get somebody that understands the dynamics of inventory, the dynamics of trade values, the dynamics like an example would be you're trading a car, it says it's worth

Sergey Lyapustin: You

Vinnie Micciche: this much, but it's Barney purple and nobody wants it. Nobody wants it. They take a grand off of it just because of the color, right? That happens in real life. And uh I don't know how Carvana or Amazon are planning on dealing with all of that. Um

they probably just take the hit. Um, I suppose because they got, you know, that's their model. Uh, but car dealers are much more savvy than that and and that's where you're going to run into a tr into a problem if you let the LLM take it too far.

00:46:37

Vinnie Micciche: Even at that 10% I think is too far personally. Now, at the moment now, what it looks like in five years, I have no idea. we could lead towards what what we're saying. But initially these this tool right here if we were just to plug in astrology PT it would give a incredible experience compared to most chat bots that are out there right now. Most chat bots to your point Sergey they get a name and phone number and say we'll get somebody to get you that information. That's all they do.

Sergey Lyapustin: No no no no no yeah yeah no I I'm I'm just saying what we can use uh that chat platform uh as a way to connect to our GPT or specifically fine-tuned for the one which we are going to build like extended customer face we do not need to ask permission for another real estate on the website or try to collaborate on how it going to look like.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: We can try to enhance our chat widget either through that quick platform.

00:47:32

Sergey Lyapustin: They already have AI support or just build something internally which going to integrate into the quick platform. So whenever we need it, we can hand off that uh chat conversation to the real agent and we can essentially configure that through our internal validation process like have some LLM or whatever process which going to decide based on their already collected information if it's time to hand off it to the real agent to kind of to address that conversation in a more reliable and like better way.

Mike Sullivan: like that.

Sergey Lyapustin: Sorry.

Vinnie Micciche: So you're saying use quick plugin chat GBT to to to take to to answer some of the the chats is what you're saying.

Sergey Lyapustin: Uh no, I I guess I guess let's try to integrate stroll GPT into the quick chat at least. So uh we can handle conversation using like uh stroll GPT brain with uh

some extra tool like we can uh like right now we have inventory integrated install GPT but it's a little bit different compared to what we should provide to the customers because we should not like show some information like uh some pricing.

00:48:49

Vinnie Micciche: customer conversations or something. Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah. like we we need to like show specific pricing based on the dealer requirements. Some of them do not want to show like price for specific vehicle. So we need to make sure we handle that properly. So some internal information wouldn't leaked there. But I I like uh the way how it's going to be quite easy to test it and start from there. uh for I don't know some of the dealers like early adopters you you said we have some someone already requested that uh so that's what I'm think

Vinnie Micciche: Yep. Yep.

Harinder Bhinder: I was going to say that since we've all kind of said this in this conversation that the chat part of it is probably the easiest part and that is what we can tackle either Starting with quick sounds really good because then we already have a a tool that we can just plug into what we have today. But it's the brain that's going to matter the most, right? So once you unleash this, then we need to make sure that we have a solid middle layer.

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Harinder Bhinder: We have the VCON, we have the conserver, we have that foundation. And I generated an infographic from your docs Vinnie using notebook LM which kind of showed it that way, right? So you have the VCON then you have server then you have the dealer brain and then you have this chatbot on top but that brain is what really matters. So we can start with the chat but we also need to focus on that platform layer so that we can scale it also right as it as it grows.

Thomas Howe: Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: So start small but what is missing in that um in that conversational layer and how do we build connectors to it and so I think we need to start thinking about sort of the high level architecture of that even if we don't start with that because that it's

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Thomas Howe: You hear me?

Mike Sullivan: I've got to go. I've got to go. But I'm I'm really aligned uh with what Herinda just said. Um that's the way to I think that's the the the you know phase zero is just do that and see where it where it stands.

00:51:13

Vinnie Micciche: All right. See, Mike.

Thomas Howe: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Michael Donovan: mic.

Vinnie Micciche: So, I I would say, right, just a couple things we need it to do. So, I do like this design, but it again, I just threw it together. I don't know if Quick can do something similar to this. I do think people need to understand two things. There's one thing we need, one thing the customer needs. Customer needs to understand that they can ask it anything. And I I urge all of you to go in and ask it anything and see if how it displays the results because it's to me I haven't seen it do anything I didn't like yet and I've been using it a lot. Astrology GPT I'm talking about for that dealer. Now to Sergey's point, we need to segregate the customer conversational data so that doesn't populate somehow, right? Or whatever. Like if you say, "Show me customers that are upset," it will probably do that, right? Like we got to make sure that we we eliminate that part of the data.

00:52:03

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: But the actual LM with the inventory, um, we have the dealer's inventory, so they can say, "What do you have in stock? Do you have this kind of a car?" And it can it can look through it and find it. Our agents that are handling the chat right now can't do that. they have to go to the website and look and meanwhile it's a minute goes by before they can actually type out an answer. You know, just saying hello very quickly is something I've been talking about. Uh or but the the thing we need is to be able to capture that customer information. There has to be a way where we let the customer know that in, you know, to validate this information, we'll need some contact information from you. Otherwise, it just goes into into vapor and no one knows what the hell the LM said from the dealer perspective. I'm just trying to connect the dots from this

environment to the dealer.

Michael Donovan: We we could also look at fingerprinting and you know there's some other methods to to find out who they are.

00:53:06

Michael Donovan: Uh I don't know if that would Yeah, I we should look at all options at this point and you know I think part of the brain it to Herenda's point you know if it has all of the conversations

Vinnie Micciche: I don't really care. I don't care how we do it, but we need to be able to connect the dot there. We have to

Michael Donovan: the emails the you know all of that historical because a lot of those questions that are asked are going to come up in in this medium. So um and then and connecting the you know the conversation uh sphere for an individual customer that made it to a a certain milestone. I think that should also be part of it somehow so we know which are sold.

Vinnie Micciche: example example is I asked for a list of upset customers one day um and it gave me one customer that was upset about something else and our agent was able to book the appointment.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: So I said, "Write me an email to that customer." And in the email it took it framed what was what the agent said, which is when you come in, ask for herinda.

00:54:16

Vinnie Micciche: She'll have all the information of everything you discuss. That's part of our process. And it picked up on that, which is great, right?

Michael Donovan: Right. Yeah, that's exactly

Vinnie Micciche: Because that's what we want. That's the kind of experience we're training our agents to give the customer. And the LLM was giving that same experience, which is pretty cool. Like that's where I that's where I'm getting scared and excited at the same time about all of this, you know, is all we have to do is coach it.

Sergey Lyapustin: as as long as as you have all all your instructions somewhere like documented uh you can you can always add it as a kind of information to their to your LLM uh whenever you want it to behave the same way and it can pick from there. Uh but

for the customerf facing chats I I don't think well we can technically also include that like information about his previous conversation and chats and calls and everything but that goes a little bit uh beyond of their easier uh simple proof of concept because we need to somehow authenticate that customer.

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Sergey Lyapustin: Make sure we only show like relevant history information to that case customer whenever we authenticate him. Either by sending some like one-time password to his phone number or to the email and only doing that which can be kind of next step if you want to go this direction.

Vinnie Micciche: So this list, this is a list right here of things we need to track. Co-pilot conversations, number of leads created, human handoff, and our typical appointment shows sold. That's something that has to be done, you know, with Kevin and and some type of of of ability for us internally to see this information and externally uh once we put it up on on the website. But I I I tried to think of everything in here. I I think we may need a longer kind of meeting. Um I don't want to spend forever on this but it aside from the core concepts of co-pilot dealer brain um strolled becoming you know uh more than just a BDC and I I have some documentation that I just shared with Michael on that some new messaging.

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Vinnie Micciche: Um all this has to be you know conceptualized and we need to start talking about it to the to our dealers.

Michael Donovan: Well, do we do we start talking?

Vinnie Micciche: We got out of the

Michael Donovan: I I think I just need a little more time with you to understand how like what that messaging looks like, but what the problem is specifically that we're solving and what the cost of inaction is. If if we can outline that uh offline, Vin, then yeah, I think we can come up with some strong messaging. Uh I'm not there yet. I'm I'm I see the big picture.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, I'm not doing it.

Michael Donovan: I I just in the for the immediate I don't I'm not connecting.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Harinder Bhinder: So one thing uh I know we want our customers to use our portal and when we do deployments for customers we they buy our portal and they live there but for our agents if we bring a co-pilot into the CXM so that when they have a customer's information already there, then they have the agent right there, the co-pilot right there to get more information about whether that's inventory.

00:57:51

Harinder Bhinder: So that way we're testing it even more as it because I understand right now there is they don't want to go to another app to now pull up information as they're speaking with someone. So that would be a good uh um

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. No, we talked about implementing I can show you another lovable um dialer screen that I built that has astrology PT built right into their dialer with a co-pilot. That was, you know, a concept that I came up with and I can show you that if you want. Michael, I just shared this with you a little while ago.

Harinder Bhinder: yeah I think yeah Vinnie I think you did share that with me.

Michael Donovan: Yep.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah. Um because that validates a lot of the data even more, right? So as our agents start using it, because if it's right where they are, then they're they're going to use it to ask questions as they're having conversations with the customer. And all the customer information is already there. So they don't have to select from a drop down and say this dealer or that customer.

00:58:55

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Sergey Lyapustin: I I I I think it's going to be too diff like even if they might reuse the same brain and some set of flex instruction but it going to be uh slightly different uh set of their tools enable it for our agent. versus their customers itself.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: I I'm not I'm not against and I'm I'm really uh I'm going to be happy if we give access to our agent to the STR GPT because it's going to help us validate some of their things. They might found some issues and uh it just help us build better tool in general and uh I don't know how they doing like their daily work right now. uh they most likely use some chat GPT or whatever tools on the side but I want them to use our

internal tools because it's already preconfigured for the dealers and uh it just should save them time and keep that information like customer information private like not share it with any other I don't think I don't think everyone everyone have access I think uh I don't remember if he gave access to all of our agent to their

00:59:54

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah, they have access to it and I think Vinnie's done training for that as well, but I don't know they're using

Vinnie Micciche: These are really loose ends that we got to start tightening up.

Shawna Behen: I don't think we did.

Sergey Lyapustin: portal.

Shawna Behen: No.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah. So, and there is like

Vinnie Micciche: The little things are very important like giving them access that the challenge is when you talk about training. Um, I can I'll go back in my notes, but it basically I have a list of all the things an LLM will not do.

Harinder Bhinder: Mhm.

Vinnie Micciche: And that's what our agents need to understand. They can't do it. There's a reason LLM aren't doing. It's the same reason we're not going to use that data for that information like giving, you know, they're not going to give exact payments. They're not going to give exact trade uh tax or registration or doc fee information. They're not going to do that. They're going to give you generalized information these LLMs. But it's good because to me as a consumer that's what I want exact payments when I'm I just want to know is it within my budget?

01:00:59

Harinder Bhinder: Right.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Is it is it going to be you know that kind of stuff. So how we translate that from a human to a human is going to be tricky and I worry about that a little bit. Uh if they're getting into sensitive information but it can give you warranty information. It can give you incentive information. They can give you all kinds of different product information, stuff that they they get asked every day.

Sergey Lyapustin: we can we can we can easily configure our prompt to to like provide a disclaimer based on those uh specific topics which you just mentioned. So whenever they try to ask or force Austral to give the exact number, it will al always provide those kind of disclaimers in the bottom. So you do not need to to teach agent specifically just uh we can fine-tune it on our end and that's all.

Matt Watson: Yep. That's right. Yeah. None of this is none of this is new tech we're talking about.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, sir.

01:01:55

Michael Donovan: Sergey, just really quick, I I wanted to uh add a little clarity.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Michael Donovan: I I wasn't proposing that we somehow take the historical conversations and then make them accessible or or have this platform kind of pick up where it left off.

Sergey Lyapustin: Mhm.

Michael Donovan: Uh, it was more like if if we could only pick one, like if we could get the sold deals, leads that that were sold and all of the conversations and emails and, you know, any of that data that we have to use that as like a a modified kind of midground training data. So, it would have the the ability to to reference what was said that led to the outcome that we're after. That if that makes any sense. I just wanted to throw a little clarity there.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah, it's yeah that's training process is generally different. uh we can try to use that uh approach internally like if you want to really build like the better best stroll GPT or whatever then we can go and try to find like ideal conversation or ideal like flow

01:03:15

Michael Donovan: Yep.

Sergey Lyapustin: which we provide for that customer which was like frustrated originally but then we did the right things and we converted him into like soul.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: It's it's different uh and like it's kind of absolut like it's it's connected somehow but it's different and we can do it like in order to optimize that flow like when we got some kind of uh historical record

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: collected or like I don't know if you want to kind of get extra extra juice out of the GPT then absolutely and yeah absolutely Mhm.

Michael Donovan: It's maybe yeah like down the road phase two phase three it's almost like what Mike was talking about he said rag and something else I think the something else This is VCON.

Vinnie Micciche: All right. So, I'm showing I'm showing this right now, Sergey, so you can see what this is. Similar to what I what pull pulled up before in terms of disclaimers and stuff. Here's what LLMs won't give customers about buying a car, even as they get crazy good is what it says.

01:04:07

Sergey Lyapustin: Mhm.

Vinnie Micciche: It's never going to give payments, taxes, and fees, rough out the door prices, or just out the door prices in general.

Sergey Lyapustin: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: But it can lock in a specific contract ready out the door price. I mean, it can't I'm sorry. It can't guarantee that the number will still be good tomorrow. Take legal responsibility for something that changes because these are the things that happen that I was expl explaining to Michael these variables that happen within a car dealership. Why customers get frustrated when they show up and the car was sold, for example, an hour before they showed up.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah. All

Vinnie Micciche: Uh it's not going to say, "Hey, you can buy the car right at this price." It's and so it'll it'll tell you. It won't give you guaranteed trade uh values. It'll give ranges. um you know and so we have to train it on exactly this you know um we don't have to train it it's already trained which is the good part to not do that and it already gives disclaimers on

01:05:05

Sergey Lyapustin: right. Yeah. Which

Vinnie Micciche: all these things so when you talk about the days of hallucination I think they caught up and they realized part of the reason these things hallucinate is because there's no b there's no uh borders you know there's no

Thomas Howe: Come

Vinnie Micciche: um structure around what they can and cannot Hey, and that's starting to happen more and more. So, that I'm I'm urging you all to go in and play with them and go into Astrology BT and ask it a pretend you're a car buyer and go ask it questions like I've been doing because it's blowing my mind at what it what it actually say. It gives disclaimers better than I would be able to think them up on the fly.

Thomas Howe: on.

Vinnie Micciche: Let's put it that way. And they're good. And and no customer could fight you in a court based on what it's telling you. Like, these are just estimates. And and frankly, that's what every dealer wants their BDC to do. They don't want to say yes.

01:06:03

Vinnie Micciche: They don't want to say no. We get caught saying yes to things like we did on Friday with a dealer where one of our managers instead of saying we won't take this deal, they say we'll take this deal and we c the dealer almost

Sergey Lyapustin: All right.

Vinnie Micciche: lost \$7,000 from a slip of a word.

Sergey Lyapustin: All

Vinnie Micciche: Like these are real things. These are like really what happens. So, no one wants to, it's not that, you know, when you're buying a car, people are trying to hide anything. They're afraid to to give you an exact without getting it verified. You know what I mean? So, they don't screw up and make a big mistake on a price.

Sergey Lyapustin: right.

Vinnie Micciche: So this is already in there.

Michael Donovan: But yeah, that and there's there's a lot about the industry, Vin, like this isn't the appropriate place to make a commitment on a on a firm number and to do a deal.

Vinnie Micciche: There's too many things can change.

Michael Donovan: Way too many.

01:06:56

Michael Donovan: Yeah, they're not they're technically not even landed on on a vehicle on a unit.

Matt Watson: Yeah, this this is a difficult problem to solve at all, guys.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Matt Watson: But

Michael Donovan: No, it's not.

Vinnie Micciche: That's what I'm saying.

Michael Donovan: So, yeah, it's awesome.

Vinnie Micciche: But it's already built in and it's built into our astrology BT just like it's built into chat GBT.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, we can we can fortify that.

Vinnie Micciche: That's why I'm saying what what do we actually have to train it?

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: That's where I'm starting to wonder what why do we have to be so careful with it.

Matt Watson: You got

Harinder Bhinder: So we all agree we need to do this. We can do this. We have the capability. Um, so I think Matt had shared sort of a road map for just picking a small handful of dealers and what tools we can use and which phone systems we can connect with. I think we should come up with a plan to just execute on that then.

01:07:45

Harinder Bhinder: Um yeah because this this seems the right direction to go right.

Matt Watson: Yeah, we'll review it tomorrow because it's pretty straightforward. Yeah, we we got to start somewhere. Quit talking about it and and make the rubber meet the road.

Harinder Bhinder: So seems like the right direction to go. So um once we have this one tool even though the traffic is not all coming from the leads are not all coming from chat bots we'll learn right. So then can we hook up more phone systems more u as customers are chatting through SMS or call phone calls we can hook up with the CRM build adapters there bring all of that data in but we have to start somewhere um

Matt Watson: Sorry.

Vinnie Micciche: Yep. And and everything I've done, it points to starting with the co-pilot.

Michael Donovan: I think I think one other

Sergey Lyapustin: I I yeah I see I see I I see two areas right now like first uh try to give access to our internal agents like through their dialer and we already kind of have started some small face lift on the dialer side.

01:08:52

Sergey Lyapustin: So we can try to either like run that small project like try to face leave dialer give access like to our internal uh agents to stroll GPT just to kind of improve the quality of the responses and help

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: them uh do their job or we can uh yeah or after that or in parallel we can also work on the some widget which going to improve that customer flow uh through their like either separate tool or like

Harinder Bhinder: Okay.

Sergey Lyapustin: even through the quick maybe replace our service bot which we built like a while ago and try to integrate those extra uh uh brain like that brain from the LLM into it and uh give some more uh information for customer in that Okay.

Harinder Bhinder: So the the reason I brought up the brain earlier the last time we had a conversation about opening up even our internal the chat GPT to all all our internal agents was that it's not connecting with all the data sources that it can.

Matt Watson: Yes.

Harinder Bhinder: So if that's not a concern, Vinnie, from what you've seen, if you are getting all the information that you need, then we should 100% do that.

01:10:16

Vinnie Micciche: Well, when you say connecting to all the data sources, what data sources are you referring to?

Harinder Bhinder: That was the question that we had pre um offsite which

Vinnie Micciche: I don't want to over complicate it uh by thinking through lots and lots of data sources. what one data source I don't want. So think about it BT they have their own version with their customer conversations in it their inventory everything for the

dealer facing that could be good for dealer facing and for agent facing but not customerf facing customerf facing

Harinder Bhinder: Mhm.

Matt Watson: Right.

Vinnie Micciche: has to exclude c other customer data uh but it can be the same the only believe it or not and I've been racking my brain on this uh the only real important piece of data uh data point is

Harinder Bhinder: Right.

Vinnie Micciche: the inventory potentially on the service side, we could but but Sergey did hit on another part. All the stuff that's already built into our dialer is important. All the dealer rules, all the dealer, you know, hours and but it even knows the dealer's hours.

01:11:17

Vinnie Micciche: It doesn't know the managers, for example, at the stores and stuff like that, but it doesn't really need that. You know what I'm saying? So, I've been trying to think of what else it would need. What do you contact a dealer for? You want to buy a car, so you need the inventory.

Harinder Bhinder: Mhm.

Vinnie Micciche: It already has all the other uh questions that I had outlined on that lovable screen um answered pretty well with the right disclaimers. I haven't yet to see it. I mean, I would I would like you guys to all play with it because maybe you're going to find something that I didn't, but I've been playing with it quite regularly. I mean, two dealers when I showed it to them like can you can you Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah. No, no, no. To be fair, it was in context of the internal agent GPT tool, which probably needs more than what customers need. That's what that's the that's what I was talking about, not for the customers.

01:12:01

Matt Watson: Yeah. Yeah. We need to lock in on on are we doing customer or are we doing internal? Yes, they will converge at some point, but we're we're going to slow this whole thing down if we try to do more than one.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Well, the customer one is almost done is what I'm saying.

Harinder Bhinder: So, can we

Vinnie Micciche: Customerf facing one.

Matt Watson: Correct. And then and the quick path I've written up is really quick.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Matt Watson: We can we can target couple dealers. We can make fake data sets that are really small and quick and efficient. Not fake, but new ones just for the pilot, the MVP. Yeah, I feel like that's let's move quick on that and and see what we can learn because we're going to build agents that are specific to each of these pieces and those can grow and be shared among internal

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, the the the the the agent one's going to be more challenging.

Matt Watson: and dealer

Vinnie Micciche: Here's why.

01:12:51

Vinnie Micciche: They have uh do we build one or do we build one for every dealer for them? Because then they have to go into a separate one for each dealer every time they to use it.

Sergey Lyapustin: I I I think I think what we can do like we can dynamically show them a specific one based on like for example if they try to select one dealer in the dialer we can kind of dynamically switch that context to specific dealer. So it's it's we we have we have that uh stroll GPC already built in place.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay, that makes sense. That makes sense, Sergey. Yeah, I didn't think so.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah. Yeah. It it just what it like currently it's only live inside of the portal. So we need to think how to Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: When the call comes up and the and their and their dialer comes up, that GP is associated to that dealer.

Harinder Bhinder: and CX1 as well.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: Right?

Sergey Lyapustin: Exactly.

Harinder Bhinder: So because as the um example is Google Workspace so now I wouldn't go and use Gemini necessarily for everything because I'm more in the chat GPT world.

01:13:49

Harinder Bhinder: But since in Google Docs now I can just click a button and say summarize this or whatever questions about the document, I'm more likely to do that, right?

Sergey Lyapustin: All

Harinder Bhinder: So I I use it more often now for that.

Vinnie Micciche: they may already be doing it. You know, our agents, I I would imagine they are, but we we we want to funnel them in a in a um controlled way, you know, something where we can capture all the their searches.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah. Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: right.

Vinnie Micciche: Like, words, if we have half of our agents using Gemini, we're losing all that data that they're searching and and looking at. We need to make sure that they're using GPT.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah. So we need let's treat these as two streams then and we need to know where we are with the internal agents and where do we want to get to and then the other stream is the customer and they do have overlap obviously the fun

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. And no offense, Matt, but I don't see this as when you say, you know, the I think both can be done.

01:14:42

Vinnie Micciche: I I I want to from what I've seen at astrology, I don't think there's a lot of heavy lifting on either side of this other than creating the the quick widget and you know or whatever that has to take place or putting it into the portal. I I know that stuff is work, don't get me wrong, but the actual bones of it are really good already. Like I I

Matt Watson: I'm just making sure we Yeah, you can totally do different swim lanes. Yeah, I wasn't arguing that. I'm just saying they're not the same product. They need to be separated because they have different requirements. But if they run in parallel, no problem. We just if an assumption for what the customer sees can't be the same for the agent and the other way around, too. That's all.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah, I I I can say what we we we potentially can't use existed solution right away for either like for customerf facing or for internal one. But we already

know like what we need to do or what we need to adjust in order that for them to work.

01:15:38

Sergey Lyapustin: It's uh it's doable. It's not uh as hard as when we built like original version of the stroll GPT. We just like potentially need to decide like okay like this next week or whatever we work on the internal tool or give access for our stroll GPT like brain for our agent through the dialer and we do that and then kind of move to external one while we still figuring out all the requirements or what we want to have in the version one.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Michael Donovan: the the I just have one quick um I I think it could be helpful for the customer facing is getting some some analytics for the the site that it's going to live on and having proper events set up.

Sergey Lyapustin: That makes sense.

Vinnie Micciche: But you know, it's funny you say that.

Michael Donovan: Oh, right.

Vinnie Micciche: I was thinking of that too, Michael. But all this is going to get fed to the brain.

Michael Donovan: Exactly.

Vinnie Micciche: So, we don't really we're going to be capturing all of it already without it having to go to a website analytic tool.

01:16:38

Matt Watson: We already captured like

Vinnie Micciche: I mean, we we know what they said if they jumped off, if they finished the conversation, if we captured information, if we didn't capture information.

Michael Donovan: Oh, what up

Vinnie Micciche: We're going to know more than what a website tool is going to teach us. But I want to hear from Jason and Shauna because they're the ones that going to be having to propo, you know, present this and uh or what they think about it, you know, internally and externally because that's it. That before before we go, I you guys can jump. I just wanted to spend more time with those two. Um you can stick around.

Shawna Behen: Yeah. Well, I think it's a good idea just for the overall experience for the

customer, you know, being able to ask the questions. Um, you know, just the overall relationship, customer, dealer. Uh, I do like the idea of it. Um, so the portal is great. It's just it is something additional that they have to log into.

01:17:35

Shawna Behen: I don't want to make it sound like I mean they're already in you know possibly eight CRM CXM dialer. So I do like it along with the dialer. Um, I do like the dialer, too.

Sergey Lyapustin: I I I can give you one more suggestion. We can technically integrate it directly to the slack. So stroll GPT can be accessible like through like stroll GPT blog.

Vinnie Micciche: I think the dialer is perfect. Sergey Yeah, I I showed you that.

Shawna Behen: When there was a level we shared, I I believe it was during the meeting, the off-site meeting we had, um, and it was just right there on the right hand side of it.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Shawna Behen: Um, but it was cleaner.

Michael Donovan: Mhm.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: I can show you it again. What else you got?

Michael Donovan: And it was dynamic, right?

Sergey Lyapustin: But but yeah, but

Shawna Behen: Like the whole look of it was clean.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Shawna Behen: The whole the dialer in g in general the dealer info.

01:18:21

Shawna Behen: Um,

Harinder Bhinder: I just have a quick question. Where does the trade in info come from?

Vinnie Micciche: The what?

Harinder Bhinder: The trade in info because we have tradeins here.

Matt Watson: couple different markets, different API endpoints.

Vinnie Micciche: You know, it's funny.

Matt Watson: We have to design with

Vinnie Micciche: It's funny you say that. When I was with um when I was showing this to

Rosenberg, he was like, "Ask it how it got the lease payment." And it told us where it got it from or the lease money factor and residual. And then I asked it about um like why would I, if I was Kelly Blue Book or Auto Trader or Blackbook, share this information with the LLM if I know eventually they're going to put me out of business, right? That was kind of my thought process. And it basically said there's so much of it out there from auction data to different and some of them you know have to for for uh insurance purposes and stuff have to publicly um submit all this data that

01:19:14

Sergey Lyapustin: Huh?

Vinnie Micciche: even you know the ones that pay people to do it are going to be in trouble. But this is what we what we built. Sergey, the co-pilot was something that could basically because Thomas is potentially doing if we ever get an agreement signed with Better Dead Solutions, a real time uh VCON, which could potentially help coach the agent along as the call

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: is happening.

Michael Donovan: We're I'm still seeing the uh other one.

Vinnie Micciche: Oh jeez, sorry.

Sergey Lyapustin: Arthur.

Vinnie Micciche: I I I didn't think I I thought I could switch screens on that. This is it right here. Sorry. So, all I did was add astrology PT up here and the co-pilot was something that could coach them while they're talking to somebody potentially. Um, and you know, we already have the scripts there. So this was the idea um where they now that would tie into that dealership's version of astrology pt not you know all of them is how we'd have to I think that's better than slack is my Jonathan

01:20:08

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah, this is

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah. Uh it it just I I'm just thinking what not all the agents using dialer potentially like we have someone like from their modcom team or else and what they can also get access to the Australia GPT this

Shawna Behen: Oh, we can give you their document, Sergey.

Sergey Lyapustin: way it it just h okay yeah and and also we need we need to move that dealer info from the external dog potentially into the CXM or some u database table.

Shawna Behen: I'll share their document. They have their own dealer info in a word doc.

Matt Watson: Oh boy.

Sergey Lyapustin: So we can also feed that information as a GPT.

Matt Watson: Yep.

Sergey Lyapustin: So when they ask question about something uh through GPT can basically get that information right away.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, this has the dealer's rules in here and everything.

Harinder Bhinder: Yeah. So all that context is on the page.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: So we can grab that.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, every dealer has its own, too.

Matt Watson: Yep.

Vinnie Micciche: So, they're all specific to that dealer.

01:21:19

Vinnie Micciche: So anyway, Jay, Jason, do you have Jason, do you have anything?

Michael Donovan: So yeah, this is really good.

Vinnie Micciche: You've been very quiet.

Jason Branham: Yeah, I mean you and I talked about this for a little while, but uh you know I think in the short term it's internal in our own dealers because we don't have anything that we can uniquely position to scale to the whole market you know to stop I mean anybody could do this right where our where our value comes in as the VCON uh and having that additional debt data.

Matt Watson: Mhm.

Jason Branham: Um, you know, and then the the problem that we're trying to solve too is just like you mentioned earlier, how do we get the customer information and pass that on to the dealer?

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Jason Branham: How do we capture that lead so to speak, you know, uh for them just talk?

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Jason Branham: Because again, a customer's behavior is and that's why we train the way we train is when they call a dealership, they're trying to get as much information as possible without giving up any of their information.

01:22:28

Jason Branham: And the dealer on the other hand is trying to give up as little information as possible and get the customers information that way they can get them into the store and/or, you know, have a way to continue to

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Jason Branham: follow up. So somewhere in the middle, you know, I think internally with dealers that we currently have or we sign up that we can easily uh put this together and make it work. To scale it and just do use it as a standalone product is a is a different task.

Vinnie Micciche: Yep. But this could be, to your point, a widget we sell dealers to replace their chat.

Matt Watson: That's the goal.

Jason Branham: Absolutely. Yeah. Absolutely.

Matt Watson: Yeah.

Jason Branham: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. That's why I like the lovable design instead of the quick design. But can you can you design a quick widget any way you want?

Matt Watson: Yes.

Vinnie Micciche: Because I don't like I I've wanted that changed for a long time.

Sergey Lyapustin: I No

Vinnie Micciche: But I I kind of you know it's funny.

01:23:23

Vinnie Micciche: I started losing interest in chat. I almost decided not to do it anymore because it's just it there's too much going on uh out there in the market. But this isn't chat. We don't want to position it as chat. We don't want to tell people it's chat. This is like a dealer LLM. as like a dealer co-pilot, an assistant, uh a customer assistance, whatever we want to call it. I have automotive co-pilot, you know, but uh we can call it whatever the hell we want and sell it.

Sergey Lyapustin: heat.

Vinnie Micciche: I just don't want to sell it as Chad because you're going to get shut down by a dealer the minute you say Chad.

Michael Donovan: Wait.

Vinnie Micciche: I already got Conor now. I already got Cuba. You know what I mean? So yeah, we just tell them this isn't a chat provider.

Matt Watson: Yeah, but you get around all those OEM requirements too around That's right.

Michael Donovan: Hey.

Jason Branham: Yeah, you run into Yeah. running into the OEM saying we only have four chat providers that are certified.

01:24:12

Vinnie Micciche: This isn't this is an assistant. This is an LLM.

Jason Branham: That's right.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, I I I think even more so now we need to have full sight visibility and analytics uh to monitor the behavior that we're influencing because yes, it may happen within the chat window, but we may also discover

Vinnie Micciche: Is it really?

Matt Watson: Yep.

Michael Donovan: that we're influencing conversions outside of this platform still on the dealer's website.

Vinnie Micciche: You know what's going to show up, Michael? Are we getting leads or not? That's it. All the other data no one cares about. Honestly, no dealer cares about. They care about whether they get a lead or not. I know you like all that stuff. I want to just see how customers know, but I want to see how customers interact with it and I want to see, to Jason's point, I want to see if we capture the customer contact information.

Michael Donovan: It's It's not It's not me then. Right.

Vinnie Micciche: I think that we will I think we'll be successful at that as long as we're providing a good experience to the customer.

01:25:03

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: I think they'll be more than happy to to give us, you know, there has to be some kind of verbiage around, you know, how we're validating uh this information for

when you show up in the showroom. Kind of like the way we do it in in on the phone. You know, by dealing with me, we're going to help save you time. The benefit of dealing with me is we're going to help save you time when you get to the showroom.

Matt Watson: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Uh something to that effect needs to be trained to these these customerf facing tools. And that's all I care about right now.

Joe Furnari: This is

Vinnie Micciche: I I want to see on the website. I want to see if it converts to leads event.

Michael Donovan: Well, that's the po that's the point right there.

Sergey Lyapustin: Okay.

Michael Donovan: So to have the full picture.

Vinnie Micciche: But but listen, I was so excited about that one thing and then I started really drilling into it and started realizing, well, the website traffic is going to start disappearing.

01:25:51

Sergey Lyapustin: Okay.

Matt Watson: Mhm.

Vinnie Micciche: I don't I don't know if anyone sees it coming as fast as I think it's going to come a lot faster than anyone's telling you.

Michael Donovan: Well,

Vinnie Micciche: A lot faster. It's not going to be overnight, but it's not going to be five years from now where people are going to be shifting to LLMs from Google.

Harinder Bhinder: Well, even Google when you go there now, search and it shows the AI response first. You don't click on the links anymore. So use for more stuff.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: All Right.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: And just there are going to be like some effect on the lead volume because if we going to be able to answer some questions right away, we might have actually less leads just because some of the customers might can might get uh not be they they might not want to go to create lead at all like after they got answer on their question like they might not fit into like uh those waste,

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, but that's the whole thing, Sergey.

01:26:55

Vinnie Micciche: That's the whole thing. They're not going to get all the answers. It's not going to say this is a definitive answer. That's my point. It's not going to give them exact

Sergey Lyapustin: right? Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. But even like if you ask for like payment or whatever you got the range on and you thought, oh no, I'm not going to be qualified if and then and previously they just fill out all the forms and it go through the CRM and we handle that lead and we still return the same answer to the customer. what you want potentially won't be qualified based on your kind of uh income or whatever but the lead which go through will be more uh yeah higher quality or like already like prepared.

Vinnie Micciche: Great quality. Yep. I agree.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: No question. And and and Michael already said it. E today we're only capturing two or 3% of the visits to a website.

01:27:45

Vinnie Micciche: Most websites are less than 2%.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: So we're not getting a lot of lead conversion there either. Um I don't know how CarGurus and all them, you know, what their calls to actions are, but they're a marketplace that's different. So that you get leads from those. True Power guarantees you a price but forces you to give your information. That's why you get a ton of leads from them and they're low quality. The high quality leads have always come from the website. But again, it's not it's not it's only two or three out of a hundred that visit.

Harinder Bhinder: Thank you.

Matt Watson: And there's nothing stopping us from delivering links to this via text message, via via email, via dealer website button, via Right. It's like you can push this out everywhere as well.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Michael Donovan: we we can also leverage the map pricing guidelines in one to one like I I have a lot of experience in this this realm in my world it's not complicated No,

Vinnie Micciche: I know.

01:28:37

Vinnie Micciche: I don't want to over complicate it. Michael, go play with go go go go go go. Yeah, it is. And and so go over go through astrology bt and ask them about map pricing and stuff like that and see what it already has there.

Matt Watson: Yeah, let us

Vinnie Micciche: So we don't have to recreate the wheel and go.

Michael Donovan: Vin. I'm I'm saying to generate the leads. It it it I'll I'll map it out, put a dock together and and we can talk about it.

Vinnie Micciche: Michael, we No, we we can talk about it offline. Yeah.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: I don't want to go down that rabbit.

Michael Donovan: All right. I have another meeting. So, good stuff.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. Are you going to get on a call with me and Z soon?

Michael Donovan: At 11. Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. Um I I'll I'll message Natalie. So, yeah. So, just to wrap up here, um the I I as you can probably tell, I know there's I wouldn't be as excited about this if I thought it was overly complicated.

01:29:36

Vinnie Micciche: I don't want to over complicate this. I think we already have the ability to move fast on this. We need to start moving fast and not slowing. No offense to Michael, but he loves to go into data and details and how we can do this and that. I already see what this can do. We and we should be using it for our agents and for our dealers as soon as we possibly can because we are experiencing churn and and and and the idea around how do we help our dealers and help our people uh faster? This this checks both the boxes, right? And the customer experience. It checks all all three. We talk about our objectives and it feeds the brain. All this information, whether it be information from our agents typing stuff in, information from the like I don't want to pretend I know everything. Let's collect the data and then figure out how to adjust it and adapt to it. And we also have friendly dealers that want to test it out with for us.

01:30:33

Vinnie Micciche: So, which is, you know, I can get David Rosenberg to agree to not sue us if something goes wrong. How about that? And Mike Blog probably, too. If they're getting leads, they're going to be happy.

Sergey Lyapustin: I I I I personally think what uh we might potentially start with a customer uh facing uh like widget or chat whatever because uh like the reason for that is what we have right now there is no uh any kind of secret source inside it's just like basic LLM and if we won't do it like there's a potential what other company going to implement something like that. Uh so like is basically like GPT right now it's just main prompt and potentially access to the inventory data and there is nothing like any any special things there. So it just as simple as that.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: So it's it's Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: But before you all assume that it's not going to be very good or it could do something wrong, go play with it. That's what I've been doing.

01:31:40

Vinnie Micciche: I just pretend you're burning a car and go on astrology bt and start asking it questions and see what you think about the experience because it blew my mind.

Sergey Lyapustin: No, no, no, no, no. I I I I Yeah, but it's what what what I what I about to say is basically the same chat GPT with just simple prompt on top. So there is no nothing uh uh no no any kind of secret knowledge which we put inside and that uh give ability anyone else to build something like that. So whoever build like first tool which easily integrate with the inventory data and potentially something else going to win I guess.

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Sergey Lyapustin: So that's what I that's that's because I propose maybe go that direction like uh first if we uh like all know what it's going to be important

Matt Watson: Right. It's a good point. Yep.

Joe Furnari: So Matt to your final point though what you what both you Sergey and Hinder had mentioned you're going to put together kind of the final framework is that when I say framework final you said you're going to meet tomorrow like how long is it going to take you to give us the framework so we can make sure that we agree on all the different features and the things that we want to develop for this that we

01:32:49

Joe Furnari: agree to it so that we're delivering what Vinnie wants.

Matt Watson: Yeah, the plan's just going to be the quick MVP, like something we can turn out really quick, throw to a dealer, test it, right?

Joe Furnari: Right. No, I agree. But are you going to present that tomorrow's standup or do you need more time?

Matt Watson: Yeah, I think we can. We I think between Sergey and myself, myself, we've discussed it a lot already, right?

Joe Furnari: Okay, perfect.

Matt Watson: I think we'll just put our heads together.

Joe Furnari: That would be great if you could turn it around in 24 hours.

Vinnie Micciche: There's already a dealer out there that's pedalling Chad. Chad GBT for automotive dealers and he's probably just really smart and realized that hey chat GBT already does everything I want it to do. We're just packaging it to your your point.

Harinder Bhinder: Yes, a lot of products today are just wrappers around these agents. So, yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. No, but what we we have the plumbing ability to to to to secure that data, right?

01:33:29

Joe Furnari: Yeah.

Sergey Lyapustin: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: To to hold it and to and to put it in like that's what that dealer doesn't have, right?

Harinder Bhinder: And you can collect multiple Yeah.

Matt Watson: right?

Vinnie Micciche: So, and connect the dots with all the CRM and everything else that that we we already have the capabilities of doing.

Harinder Bhinder: So we can we're not going to do just this is just the beginning, right?

Vinnie Micciche: So, yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: So for us it's not just the chat, it's everything every which way the customer is interacting with the dealer. We will have all of that, right? And we can

converge that and then present that in a cohesive way. So it's it's different from just answering questions.

Vinnie Micciche: And just just remember what I was pushing back on.

Joe Furnari: Yeah, it's a closed loop system. That's what it's going to be extremely powerful.

Vinnie Micciche: Just remember what I was pushing back on Michael about. It's really simple. It has to deliver some type of lead or some type of experience, better exper.

01:34:17

Vinnie Micciche: There's got to be some type of way we capture what's going on in this and show the dealer because that's what they want. They want to be able to sell more cars. They want the friction gone. I I I totally understand that. That's why they all signed up with digital retailing tools and why they have chat and why they have BDC's. But this has to be presented in a way where it's it eliminates the friction and gives and and responds to the customer quickly, fast, responsibly and so forth. And that's how we need to market it. And once it if it turns out leads, we're it's it's going to be a gold mine. And then we can move on to all the other pieces that you're talking about, Herrena, which I I'm not saying this is the end all be all.

Harinder Bhinder: Great.

Vinnie Micciche: This is the beginning. All right. Good. What are we going to say, Joe? Sorry I cut you off a little.

Joe Furnari: No, no, I just what I was saying is it's it's essentially not day one, but it's a closed loop system to Hendrenda's point is we're bringing all the end to end um elements of a lead in the communication

01:35:09

Sergey Lyapustin: I don't want There we go.

Joe Furnari: and organization with a customer which is unlike what you just mentioned where you're whoever that was that's you know throwing a chat GBT there. Um, this is what ultimately will be a massive differentiator between us and others. Again, I think Michael brings up a good point around is the the source volume of chat um is that going to be a risk, but we'll see.

Matt Watson: Yeah, that's the only

Thomas Howe: I I love this graphic by the way because it's quite clever.

Harinder Bhinder: This is what notebook LM generated based on all your doc.

Vinnie Micciche: Oh, nice.

Harinder Bhinder: So we we've already done these two which is I think the biggest well yeah there's the human escalation layer but it's autobc so um yeah it didn't specifically add the copilot in there

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. The only thing that's missing is the co-pilot. You know, the the thing is we've been thinking of a new word for um BDC. We could just call it automotive co-pilot. That's what we are as a company.

Thomas Howe: Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: and And that agent that we're building, it's I mean what the co-pilot we're building, it's an agent, right? It's just using AI versus a human.

Matt Watson: Yeah.

Harinder Bhinder: How do I stop here?

Thomas Howe: Come on.

Joe Furnari: Okay. Well, um, we'll see where we're at in 24 hours.

Harinder Bhinder: Okay.

Joe Furnari: I think that's great. Matt, Herender, Sergey, if you want to bounce anything off of me, feel free to reach out.

Vinnie Micciche: I may or may not be working from home tomorrow, but I'll be on the call.

Matt Watson: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: Depends on how bad No.

Transcription ended after 01:37:03

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